



BEKWAI YOUTH MOVEMENT

Harnessing the Potential of Every Young Person in Sefwi Bekwai and Its 31 Sub-Communities

BEKWAI YOUTH PARLIAMENT STANDING ORDERS

*Rules and Procedures Governing the Conduct of Business
of the Legislative Chamber of the Bekwai Youth Movement*

*Enacted by the BYM Youth General Assembly
pursuant to Article 18 of the BYM Constitution*

Sefwi Bekwai, Western North Region, Republic of Ghana
Membership: Ages 10 to 45 | Non-Partisan | Community-Rooted

BYP/SO/2025 — First Edition



PREAMBLE

WE, the Members of the Bekwai Youth Parliament, constituted pursuant to Article 18 of the Constitution of the Bekwai Youth Movement, and acting in exercise of the legislative authority vested in the Parliament by that Constitution:

RECOGNISING that the Parliament is the supreme legislative chamber of the Bekwai Youth Movement, charged with the solemn responsibility of giving legislative expression to the aspirations and interests of all young people in Bekwai and its thirty-one sub-communities;

CONSCIOUS of the duty imposed upon every Member of Parliament to conduct themselves with dignity, integrity, and respect for the institution, for fellow Members, and for the communities they represent;

AFFIRMING the Movement's foundational principles of non-partisanship, inclusivity, transparency, and democratic accountability;

DETERMINED to establish clear, fair, and enforceable rules that shall govern the conduct of all business before the Parliament;

DO HEREBY ADOPT AND ENACT these Standing Orders as the supreme procedural instrument of the Bekwai Youth Parliament:



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PART I PRELIMINARY

ARTICLE 1 — CITATION AND COMMENCEMENT

ORDER 1.1 — Short Title

- (1) These Rules shall be cited as the Bekwai Youth Parliament Standing Orders, 2025, and may also be referred to as the "Standing Orders" or abbreviated as "BYP-SO".

ORDER 1.2 — Commencement

- (1) These Standing Orders shall come into force upon adoption by resolution of the BYM Youth General Assembly and shall remain in force until amended or revoked in accordance with Article 40 hereof.
- (2) These Standing Orders shall, upon commencement, supersede all prior procedural resolutions, conventions, and practices of the Parliament to the extent of any inconsistency.

ARTICLE 2 — APPLICATION AND SCOPE

ORDER 2.1 — Binding Nature

- (1) These Standing Orders shall be binding upon every Member of Parliament, every Officer of Parliament, and every person present in the precincts of the Parliament during a sitting.
- (2) Any person who wilfully disregards or contravenes any provision of these Standing Orders shall be subject to such sanctions as are prescribed herein or as the Speaker may in their discretion direct.

ORDER 2.2 — Supplementary Provisions

- (1) Where a matter arises in the Parliament that is not expressly provided for by these Standing Orders, the Speaker shall rule on the matter, having regard to parliamentary practice in the Republic of Ghana, the Constitution of the Bekwai Youth Movement, and the principles of fairness, efficiency, and democratic governance.
- (2) Any ruling of the Speaker made under sub-order (1) shall be recorded in the Speaker's Rulings Register and shall constitute a persuasive precedent for future proceedings.

ORDER 2.3 — Relationship with BYM Constitution

- (1) These Standing Orders shall be construed in a manner consistent with the Constitution of the Bekwai Youth Movement. Where any provision of these Standing Orders is found to be in conflict with the BYM Constitution, the BYM Constitution shall prevail, and the conflicting provision shall be read down to the extent of the inconsistency.

ARTICLE 3 — DEFINITIONS AND INTERPRETATION

ORDER 3.1 — General Definitions

In these Standing Orders, unless the context otherwise requires:

- "Assembly"** means the BYM Youth General Assembly, being the executive organ of the Movement constituted under Article 13 of the BYM Constitution;
- "Bill"** means a formal proposal for legislation introduced before the Parliament for deliberation and approval;
- "BYM Constitution"** means the Constitution of the Bekwai Youth Movement as may from time to time be amended;
- "Chamber"** means the main hall or room in which the Parliament holds its formal sittings;
- "Clerk"** means the Clerk of Parliament appointed under Order 10.1 of these Standing Orders;
- "Committee"** means any Standing Committee or Ad Hoc Committee of Parliament established under Part VIII hereof;
- "Deputy Speaker"** means a Deputy Speaker of Parliament appointed under Article 9 of these Standing Orders;
- "Division"** means the process of determining the result of a vote by requiring Members to indicate their votes individually;
- "Floor"** means the area of the Chamber within which Members of Parliament sit and participate in debate during sittings;
- "Hansard"** means the official verbatim record of parliamentary debates, proceedings, and decisions as maintained pursuant to Order 38;
- "Member"** means a person duly admitted as a Member of Parliament in accordance with Article 6 hereof;
- "Motion"** means a formal proposal placed before Parliament by a Member requesting Parliament to take a particular course of action or express a particular view;
- "Parliament"** means the Bekwai Youth Parliament, being the legislative chamber of the Bekwai Youth Movement established under Article 18 of the BYM Constitution;
- "Point of Order"** means an objection raised by a Member during debate on the ground that a provision of these Standing Orders or parliamentary procedure is being violated;
- "Quorum"** means the minimum number of Members required to be present for the Parliament to lawfully conduct business;
- "Resolution"** means a formal decision of Parliament adopted pursuant to an approved motion;
- "Session"** means a period during which Parliament meets regularly for the dispatch of business, as described in Article 12;
- "Sitting"** means a single meeting of Parliament on a particular day;
- "Speaker"** means the Speaker of the Bekwai Youth Parliament holding office under Article 8 of these Standing Orders;
- "Strangers"** means any person present in the Chamber during a sitting who is not a Member, Officer, or duly accredited staff of Parliament;

ORDER 3.2 — Rules of Interpretation



- (1) Unless the context otherwise requires, words importing the masculine gender shall include the feminine gender and vice versa; words in the singular shall include the plural and vice versa.
- (2) A reference to an "Article" shall be to an Article of these Standing Orders. A reference to an "Order" shall be to an order within an Article of these Standing Orders.
- (3) Headings, sub-headings, and side-notes are for ease of reference only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision.

PART II

CONSTITUTION AND MEMBERSHIP OF PARLIAMENT

ARTICLE 4 — COMPOSITION OF PARLIAMENT

ORDER 4.1 — Membership Complement

- (1) The Parliament shall consist of Members elected or appointed from the communities of Bekwai and its thirty-one sub-communities in accordance with the BYM Constitution.
- (2) Each community shall be represented in Parliament by not fewer than one Member. The Assembly may, by resolution, prescribe a higher representation for communities with significantly larger youth populations.

ORDER 4.2 — Ex Officio Members

- (1) The following persons shall be ex officio, non-voting members of Parliament: (a) the Clerk of Parliament; (b) such legal advisers as the Assembly may attach to Parliament from time to time.
- (2) Ex officio members shall not participate in debate or voting save in performance of their official functions.

ARTICLE 5 — QUALIFICATIONS AND DISQUALIFICATIONS OF MEMBERS

ORDER 5.1 — Qualifications

- (1) A person shall be qualified for membership of Parliament if that person: (a) is a citizen of Ghana or a person ordinarily resident in Bekwai or any of its thirty-one sub-communities; (b) is between the ages of ten (10) and forty-five (45) years; (c) has been duly nominated, elected, or appointed in accordance with the BYM Constitution and these Standing Orders; (d) has taken and subscribed to the Oath of Office set out in Schedule I hereto.

ORDER 5.2 — Disqualifications

- (1) A person shall be disqualified from membership of Parliament if that person: (a) holds any elective public office in the Republic of Ghana, including membership of the District, Municipal, or Metropolitan Assembly, or of the Parliament of Ghana; (b) has been convicted of a criminal offence involving dishonesty or moral turpitude; (c) is of unsound mind as determined by a competent medical authority; (d) is an undischarged bankrupt; (e) has been found guilty of a disciplinary offence resulting in expulsion from the BYM by the Assembly.
- (2) Any Member who becomes subject to any disqualification under sub-order (1) during their tenure shall vacate their seat forthwith and shall notify the Speaker accordingly within forty-eight (48) hours.

ARTICLE 6 — COMMENCEMENT AND DURATION OF MEMBERSHIP

**ORDER 6.1 — Commencement**

- (1) Membership of Parliament shall commence upon the taking and subscription of the Oath of Office before the Speaker or such other person as the Assembly may designate.
- (2) A Member shall not participate in any proceeding of Parliament prior to taking the Oath of Office.

ORDER 6.2 — Duration and Vacation

- (1) The tenure of a Member shall be as prescribed by the BYM Constitution.
- (2) A Member's seat shall become vacant upon: (a) death; (b) resignation in writing addressed to the Speaker; (c) disqualification under Order 5.2; (d) prolonged absence without leave as prescribed in Order 6.3; (e) expulsion by Parliament pursuant to Article 36.

ORDER 6.3 — Leave of Absence

- (1) A Member who is unable to attend a sitting for any reason shall apply in writing to the Speaker for leave of absence, stating the reason and anticipated duration thereof.
- (2) A Member who is absent from three (3) consecutive sittings without leave of the Speaker shall be subject to a formal inquiry by the Clerk, and the Speaker may declare the seat vacant if the Member fails to provide a satisfactory explanation within fourteen (14) days.

ARTICLE 7 — REGISTER OF MEMBERS**ORDER 7.1 — Maintenance of Register**

- (1) The Clerk shall maintain an up-to-date Register of Members, which shall contain: (a) full name; (b) date of birth; (c) community of representation; (d) date of commencement of membership; (e) date and reason for vacation of seat, where applicable.
- (2) The Register shall be open for inspection by any Member or any member of the public during the Clerk's official office hours upon reasonable notice.
- (3) The Clerk shall present a report on the state of the Register at the commencement of each new parliamentary Session.

PART III OFFICERS OF PARLIAMENT

ARTICLE 8 — THE SPEAKER

ORDER 8.1 — Election and Tenure

- (1) Parliament shall, at its first sitting following the commencement of each parliamentary Session, elect a Speaker from among its Members by secret ballot.
- (2) The Speaker shall serve for the duration of the parliamentary Session unless removed from office earlier in accordance with these Standing Orders.
- (3) A retiring Speaker shall be eligible for re-election for one (1) additional term only.

ORDER 8.2 — Removal of Speaker

- (1) The Speaker may be removed from office by a resolution supported by not less than two-thirds (2/3) of all Members of Parliament.
- (2) Notice of a motion for the removal of the Speaker shall be given in writing to the Clerk not less than seven (7) days before the sitting at which the motion is to be moved.
- (3) During the proceedings for the removal of the Speaker, a Deputy Speaker shall preside.

ORDER 8.3 — Functions and Powers of the Speaker

- (1) The Speaker shall: (a) preside over all sittings of Parliament and maintain order in the Chamber; (b) call the Parliament to order and open each sitting; (c) regulate debate in accordance with these Standing Orders; (d) put questions and declare results of votes; (e) rule on Points of Order and other procedural matters, which rulings shall be final subject only to an immediate challenge under Order 8.4; (f) sign all Acts, Resolutions, and official communications of Parliament; (g) represent Parliament in its external relations; (h) supervise the staff of Parliament through the Clerk; (i) perform such other functions as are conferred by these Standing Orders or the BYM Constitution.

ORDER 8.4 — Challenge to Speaker's Ruling

- (1) A Member may challenge the Speaker's ruling on a procedural matter by immediately rising and saying: "Mr./Madam Speaker, I respectfully challenge your ruling."
- (2) The Speaker shall then put the question: "That the ruling of the Speaker be upheld." If the motion is defeated by a simple majority of Members present and voting, the ruling shall be overturned.
- (3) No debate shall be permitted on a challenge to the Speaker's ruling. The challenge shall be disposed of immediately by vote.

ORDER 8.5 — Casting Vote

- (1) The Speaker shall not vote on any matter coming before Parliament save in the event of an equality of votes, in which case the Speaker shall have a casting vote only. The Speaker shall exercise the casting vote in a manner consistent with the best interests of the Parliament and the communities it represents.



ARTICLE 9 — DEPUTY SPEAKERS

ORDER 9.1 — Election of Deputy Speakers

- (1) Parliament shall elect not more than two (2) Deputy Speakers at its first sitting of each Session. Deputy Speakers shall be elected by simple majority of Members present and voting.
- (2) The First Deputy Speaker shall act as Speaker in the absence of the Speaker or when the Speaker is incapacitated or is otherwise unable to perform the functions of the office.
- (3) The Second Deputy Speaker shall act as Speaker when both the Speaker and the First Deputy Speaker are absent or unable to act.

ORDER 9.2 — Powers and Functions

- (1) When presiding over a sitting, a Deputy Speaker shall have all the powers and functions of the Speaker.
- (2) A Deputy Speaker shall have the right to vote as a Member in all circumstances, including when presiding, save that a Deputy Speaker shall not exercise a casting vote.

ARTICLE 10 — CLERK OF PARLIAMENT AND STAFF

ORDER 10.1 — Appointment and Tenure

- (1) The Assembly shall appoint a Clerk of Parliament, who shall be the chief administrative officer of Parliament.
- (2) The Clerk shall serve at the pleasure of the Assembly but shall not be removed without just cause.

ORDER 10.2 — Functions of the Clerk

- (1) The Clerk shall: (a) attend all sittings of Parliament and all Committee meetings; (b) maintain the Hansard, Minutes, and official records of Parliament; (c) give effect to all administrative decisions of the Speaker; (d) issue notices of sittings to Members; (e) receive and process all Bills, motions, petitions, and other business; (f) maintain the Register of Members; (g) perform such other functions as the Speaker or Assembly may direct.

ORDER 10.3 — Parliamentary Staff

- (1) The Assembly may provide for such additional staff as may be necessary for the efficient administration of Parliament, who shall serve under the direction of the Clerk.

ARTICLE 11 — SERJEANT-AT-ARMS

ORDER 11.1 — Appointment

- (1) The Speaker shall appoint a Serjeant-at-Arms from among the Members or staff of Parliament.

ORDER 11.2 — Functions



- (1)** The Serjeant-at-Arms shall: (a) maintain order and security in the precincts of Parliament under the direction of the Speaker; (b) execute the directions of the Speaker regarding the removal of Members or strangers; (c) carry the mace of Parliament when in use; (d) announce the arrival and departure of the Speaker at sittings.

PART IV

SESSIONS AND SITTINGS

ARTICLE 12 — PARLIAMENTARY SESSIONS

ORDER 12.1 — Annual Sessions

- (1) Parliament shall hold not fewer than two (2) regular Sessions in each calendar year, to be known as the First Session and the Second Session.
- (2) The Assembly shall, not less than twenty-one (21) days before the commencement of each Session, give notice of the opening date, venue, and anticipated duration of the Session to all Members.
- (3) Each regular Session shall last not less than two (2) months, unless Parliament otherwise resolves by special majority.

ORDER 12.2 — Extraordinary Sessions

- (1) An extraordinary Session of Parliament may be convened by the Speaker upon: (a) the written request of not less than one-third ($\frac{1}{3}$) of all Members; (b) the direction of the Assembly in cases of urgency; or (c) the Speaker's own initiative in exceptional circumstances affecting the Movement.
- (2) Notice of an extraordinary Session shall be given not less than seven (7) days before the date of sitting, except in cases of extreme urgency where forty-eight (48) hours' notice shall suffice.

ARTICLE 13 — SITTINGS OF PARLIAMENT

ORDER 13.1 — Days and Hours of Sitting

- (1) Parliament shall sit on such days and at such hours as the Speaker shall appoint, subject to any resolution of Parliament to the contrary.
- (2) Ordinarily, Parliament shall not sit on public holidays, days of national observance, or days of religious festivals widely observed in the Bekwai community, unless the Speaker determines it necessary in the public interest.

ORDER 13.2 — Order of Business

- (1) Subject to any direction of the Speaker, the order of business at each sitting shall be as follows: (a) Prayers and Invocation; (b) Confirmation of the Minutes of the Previous Sitting; (c) Matters Arising from the Minutes; (d) Communications from the Speaker; (e) Presentation of Petitions; (f) Questions; (g) Government and Assembly Business; (h) Private Members' Business; (i) Notices of Motion; (j) Any Other Business approved by the Speaker; (k) Adjournment.
- (2) The Speaker may, with the concurrence of Parliament, vary the order of business to suit the exigencies of a particular sitting.

ORDER 13.3 — Sitting in Public



- (1) All sittings of Parliament shall be open to the public unless Parliament resolves, by special majority, to sit in camera.
- (2) Parliament shall not sit in camera except where it is necessary to: (a) protect the identity of a minor; (b) discuss matters affecting the security or integrity of the Movement; or (c) receive evidence or information of a confidential nature.

ARTICLE 14 — QUORUM

ORDER 14.1 — Quorum Requirement

- (1) The quorum of Parliament for the transaction of business shall be one-third (1/3) of the total membership of Parliament, plus one.

ORDER 14.2 — Lack of Quorum

- (1) If at any time during a sitting a Member draws the Speaker's attention to the absence of a quorum, the Speaker shall cause the division bell to ring for five (5) minutes.
- (2) If at the expiration of five (5) minutes a quorum is not present, the Speaker shall adjourn Parliament to the next sitting day or to such time as the Speaker may direct.
- (3) The absence of a quorum shall not invalidate any proceedings already concluded prior to the attention of the Speaker being drawn to it.

ARTICLE 15 — ADJOURNMENT

ORDER 15.1 — Adjournment of Parliament

- (1) Parliament may adjourn from time to time by its own resolution or by the direction of the Speaker in the following circumstances: (a) lack of quorum; (b) grave disorder; (c) completion of the business of the day.

ORDER 15.2 — Adjournment Debate

- (1) A Member may, with the leave of the Speaker, move the adjournment of Parliament for the purpose of discussing a definite matter of urgent public importance affecting the Movement or the communities it represents.
- (2) Leave shall be granted only if the Speaker is satisfied that the matter is definite, urgent, and of sufficient importance to justify immediate debate.

PART V

ORDER AND DECORUM

ARTICLE 16 — CONDUCT OF MEMBERS

ORDER 16.1 — General Standards

- (1) Every Member shall at all times, whether within or outside the Chamber, conduct themselves in a manner that reflects well upon Parliament and the Bekwai Youth Movement.
- (2) In the Chamber, a Member shall: (a) bow to the Chair upon entering and leaving; (b) address all remarks to the Speaker and not to any individual Member directly; (c) refer to other Members by their designated title and community (e.g., "the Honourable Member for Amoafu"); (d) remain seated and silent when not recognised to speak; (e) not move around the Chamber unnecessarily during a sitting; (f) not obstruct the view of or access to the Speaker's chair.

ORDER 16.2 — Use of Name

- (1) Every Member shall be addressed as "Honourable Member for [Community Name]" during parliamentary proceedings. The Speaker shall be addressed as "Mr. Speaker" or "Madam Speaker" as appropriate. Deputy Speakers shall be addressed as "Mr. Deputy Speaker" or "Madam Deputy Speaker".

ORDER 16.3 — Prohibited Conduct

- (1) No Member shall during a sitting: (a) read newspapers, books, or unrelated materials; (b) eat or drink (save for water) inside the Chamber; (c) use mobile phones or electronic devices in a manner that disrupts proceedings; (d) engage in private conversation while another Member is speaking; (e) make offensive or threatening gestures; (f) use social media to publish proceedings in real time without the Speaker's leave; (g) leave the Chamber without informing the Serjeant-at-Arms.

ARTICLE 17 — DRESS CODE

ORDER 17.1 — Standard of Dress

- (1) Every Member and Officer of Parliament shall attend sittings dressed in a manner that is respectful, dignified, and appropriate for a formal legislative assembly. Acceptable attire shall include: (a) formal business wear (suit, blouse, trousers, skirt); (b) traditional Ghanaian attire (kente, smock, batakari); (c) school uniform where a Member is a student aged below eighteen (18) years.
- (2) The Speaker shall have authority to refuse admission to the Chamber to any Member not appropriately dressed and to direct them to return properly attired.

ARTICLE 18 — MOBILE DEVICES AND ELECTRONIC EQUIPMENT

ORDER 18.1 — Use During Sittings

- (1) All mobile phones and electronic devices brought into the Chamber shall be placed on silent mode during sittings.
- (2) Recording devices (cameras, voice recorders, mobile phones) shall not be operated within the Chamber without the prior written leave of the Speaker.
- (3) Accredited members of the media and official parliamentary recorders are exempted from sub-order (2) but shall operate from designated areas only.

ARTICLE 19 — STRANGERS AND VISITORS

ORDER 19.1 — Admission of Strangers

- (1) Strangers may be admitted to designated public galleries during sittings of Parliament at the discretion of the Speaker.
- (2) Any Member may move without notice that strangers be ordered to withdraw. Such a motion shall be put forthwith without debate.

ORDER 19.2 — Conduct of Strangers

- (1) Strangers admitted to the Chamber shall not: (a) speak, communicate with Members, or create any disturbance; (b) display banners, placards, or any form of protest material; (c) record proceedings without the Speaker's permission. The Speaker may order the removal of any stranger who violates this Order.

PART VI DEBATES AND SPEECHES

ARTICLE 20 — GENERAL RULES OF DEBATE

ORDER 20.1 — Recognition to Speak

- (1) No Member shall speak in Parliament unless first recognised by the Speaker. A Member wishing to speak shall rise from their seat and catch the Speaker's eye.
- (2) The Speaker shall have full discretion in recognising Members and in ensuring balanced and fair participation in debate.

ORDER 20.2 — Relevance

- (1) Every speech in Parliament shall be relevant to the subject under debate. The Speaker may call a Member to order if their speech is irrelevant, repetitive, or designed to obstruct business.

ORDER 20.3 — Sub Judice Rule

- (1) No Member shall refer in debate to any matter that is the subject of active proceedings before a court of law or a formal tribunal, where such reference could prejudice the proceedings.

ORDER 20.4 — Matters Already Decided

- (1) No Member shall reopen discussion on any matter on which Parliament has already made a final decision within the same Session, except by way of a motion for reconsideration supported by a two-thirds (2/3) majority.

ORDER 20.5 — Reading of Speeches

- (1) A Member shall not read a prepared speech verbatim. A Member may, however, refer to notes, quotations, statistics, or other written materials to support their oral presentation.

ARTICLE 21 — TIME LIMITS ON SPEECHES

ORDER 21.1 — Standard Time Limits

- (1) Unless the Speaker otherwise directs, the following time limits shall apply to speeches: (a) mover of a substantive motion or Bill — fifteen (15) minutes; (b) seconder — five (5) minutes; (c) contribution to debate — seven (7) minutes; (d) reply by the mover — five (5) minutes.

ORDER 21.2 — Extension of Time

- (1) A Member may, with the leave of the Speaker, speak beyond the prescribed time limit. The Speaker may grant an extension of not more than three (3) additional minutes.

ORDER 21.3 — Closure of Debate



- (1) Any Member may, at any time, move: "That the question be now put." The Speaker shall put this motion without debate. If carried by a simple majority, debate shall be closed immediately and the original question put.
- (2) The Speaker may refuse to accept a closure motion if of the opinion that the question has not been sufficiently debated or that the motion is being moved to suppress legitimate minority views.

ARTICLE 22 — POINTS OF ORDER, INFORMATION, AND PERSONAL EXPLANATION

ORDER 22.1 — Point of Order

- (1) A Member may rise on a Point of Order at any time during a debate by saying: "Mr./Madam Speaker, on a Point of Order." The Speaker shall immediately call the Member to order and require the member speaking to yield the floor temporarily.
- (2) A Point of Order must relate strictly to: (a) an alleged breach of these Standing Orders; (b) an alleged misquotation of a Member; (c) an alleged factual error of a verifiable nature that is directly material to the debate.
- (3) The Speaker's ruling on a Point of Order shall be final subject to challenge under Order 8.4.
- (4) A Point of Order shall not be used as a device to interrupt a speech for tactical purposes unrelated to a genuine procedural concern. Abuse of Points of Order shall be subject to sanction under Article 35.

ORDER 22.2 — Point of Information

- (1) A Member may, with the consent of the Member on the floor, offer a Point of Information by briefly supplying a relevant and verifiable fact or correction. The Member on the floor has absolute discretion to accept or decline a Point of Information.

ORDER 22.3 — Personal Explanation

- (1) A Member who has been misquoted, misrepresented, or whose character has been impugned during debate may, with the leave of the Speaker, make a brief personal explanation at the end of the sitting.
- (2) A personal explanation shall be confined strictly to the matter of misrepresentation and shall not be used to re-enter a debate that is closed or to attack another Member.

ARTICLE 23 — UNPARLIAMENTARY LANGUAGE

ORDER 23.1 — Prohibition

- (1) No Member shall use in Parliament language that is: (a) offensive, abusive, or threatening towards any other Member or any person; (b) vulgar, obscene, or indecent; (c) deliberately misleading or calculated to deceive Parliament; (d) defamatory of any person; (e) ethnically, religiously, or socially discriminatory; (f) calculated to excite disaffection or disrespect towards the Movement or its leadership structures.

**ORDER 23.2 — Withdrawal**

- (1) Where the Speaker rules that language used by a Member is unparliamentary, the Member shall immediately withdraw the offending words unconditionally and, where appropriate, apologise to Parliament.
- (2) A refusal to withdraw unparliamentary language shall constitute misconduct and may result in the Member being named under Article 36.

ORDER 23.3 — Expunging from Record

- (1) The Speaker may direct that unparliamentary words be expunged from the Hansard. A note shall be made in the Hansard that certain words were directed to be expunged.

ARTICLE 24 — RIGHT OF REPLY

ORDER 24.1 — Mover's Right of Reply

- (1) The mover of a substantive motion or the sponsor of a Bill shall have the right of reply at the close of debate before the question is put.
- (2) No other Member shall speak after the mover's reply has commenced. The right of reply shall not be delegated to another Member.

PART VII

LEGISLATION AND MOTIONS

ARTICLE 25 — CATEGORIES OF BUSINESS

ORDER 25.1 — Government and Assembly Business

- (1) Government and Assembly Business comprises: (a) Bills and legislative proposals referred to Parliament by the Assembly; (b) reports, recommendations, or requests submitted by the Assembly to Parliament for deliberation; (c) annual budgetary and financial matters of the Movement.

ORDER 25.2 — Private Members' Business

- (1) Private Members' Business comprises motions, Bills, or petitions introduced by individual Members of Parliament acting on their own initiative or on behalf of their constituents.

ORDER 25.3 — Priority of Business

- (1) Government and Assembly Business shall take priority over Private Members' Business, except where the Speaker, in the interest of justice or urgency, otherwise directs.

ARTICLE 26 — BILLS

ORDER 26.1 — Introduction of Bills

- (1) A Bill may be introduced in Parliament by: (a) the President of the Assembly on behalf of the Assembly (Government Bill); (b) any Member of Parliament (Private Member's Bill).
- (2) A Bill shall be submitted to the Clerk in the standard form prescribed in Schedule III hereto, at least seven (7) days before the sitting at which it is to be introduced.
- (3) The Clerk shall distribute copies of all Bills to every Member not less than forty-eight (48) hours before the sitting at which the Bill is to be introduced.

ORDER 26.2 — Readings of a Bill

- (1) Every Bill shall pass through three (3) readings before it is considered adopted by Parliament.
- (2) First Reading: The Clerk shall read the short title of the Bill. No debate shall take place at First Reading, which serves solely as the formal introduction of the Bill.
- (3) Second Reading: The mover shall move that the Bill be read a second time. Debate at Second Reading shall be confined to the general principles and policy of the Bill. Parliament shall vote at the end of Second Reading on whether the Bill should proceed.
- (4) Committee Stage: If a Bill is approved at Second Reading, it shall stand referred to the relevant Standing Committee (or a Select Committee appointed by the Speaker) for detailed clause-by-clause scrutiny. The Committee shall report to Parliament within such time as the Speaker may direct.



- (5) Third Reading: Following the Committee's report, Parliament shall consider the Bill as amended and vote on whether to adopt it in its final form. At Third Reading, debate shall be confined to the text of the Bill as reported by the Committee.

ORDER 26.3 — Assent and Promulgation

- (1) A Bill adopted at Third Reading shall be presented to the Speaker for signature and thereafter transmitted to the Assembly for information and implementation.
- (2) A Bill adopted by Parliament shall have the force of a parliamentary Resolution and shall be binding on all organs of the Movement unless the Assembly, by a two-thirds majority, rejects the Bill on constitutional grounds.

ORDER 26.4 — Emergency Bills

- (1) In cases of extreme urgency, the Speaker may, with the consent of Parliament by a two-thirds majority, allow a Bill to be read more than once on the same day.

ARTICLE 27 — RESOLUTIONS AND MOTIONS

ORDER 27.1 — Notice of Motion

- (1) A Member wishing to move a substantive motion shall give notice to the Clerk in the form prescribed in Schedule II hereto, not less than forty-eight (48) hours before the sitting at which the motion is to be moved.
- (2) The Speaker may, in cases of urgency and with the consent of Parliament, allow a motion to be moved without the prescribed notice.

ORDER 27.2 — Amendment of Motions

- (1) An amendment to a motion may be moved by any Member. An amendment shall not be so broad as to constitute a contrary motion or to negate the substance of the original motion.
- (2) If an amendment is adopted, the motion shall stand as amended, and the amended motion shall be the question put to Parliament for final approval.

ORDER 27.3 — Withdrawal of Motions

- (1) The mover of a motion may withdraw it at any time before it is seconded. After secondment, withdrawal shall require the consent of the seconder and leave of Parliament by simple majority.

ARTICLE 28 — PETITIONS

ORDER 28.1 — Presentation of Petitions

- (1) Any Member may present to Parliament a petition on behalf of constituents or other members of the public. A petition shall: (a) be in writing; (b) be respectful in language; (c) be signed by the petitioner(s); (d) state the grievance or matter on which redress is sought; (e) be submitted to the Clerk not less than forty-eight (48) hours before the sitting.



- (2) The Clerk shall examine each petition for compliance with sub-order (1) and shall report to the Speaker. The Speaker shall determine whether the petition is in order before it is presented.

ORDER 28.2 — Referral of Petitions

- (1) All petitions received by Parliament shall be referred to the appropriate Standing Committee for consideration and report within twenty-one (21) days.

ARTICLE 29 — QUESTIONS AND INTERPELLATIONS

ORDER 29.1 — Questions to the Assembly

- (1) Any Member may address written questions to the President of the Assembly or to any Secretary of State, requesting information on matters falling within the purview of the Assembly and of direct relevance to the Movement and the communities it serves.
- (2) Questions shall be submitted to the Clerk not less than seven (7) days before the sitting at which they are to be answered.

ORDER 29.2 — Supplementary Questions

- (1) A Member who has asked a question may put not more than two (2) supplementary questions arising directly from the answer given, with the leave of the Speaker.

ORDER 29.3 — Interpellations

- (1) A Member may, with not less than fourteen (14) days' notice to the Clerk, interpellate the President of the Assembly on a matter of general policy of critical importance to the Movement.
- (2) An interpellation shall be followed by a debate of not more than forty-five (45) minutes, after which the President of the Assembly shall have the right of final reply.

PART VIII COMMITTEES

ARTICLE 30 — STANDING COMMITTEES

ORDER 30.1 — Establishment

- (1) Parliament shall establish the following Standing Committees at the commencement of each Session: (a) the Committee on Education, Youth, and Skills Development; (b) the Committee on Health, Sanitation, and Environment; (c) the Committee on Agriculture, Trade, and Economic Development; (d) the Committee on Community Infrastructure and Housing; (e) the Committee on Gender, Social Welfare, and Inclusion; (f) the Committee on Security, Peace, and Conflict Resolution; (g) the Committee on Rules, Privileges, and Disciplinary Matters; (h) the Committee on Finance and Resource Mobilisation.
- (2) The Speaker may establish additional Standing Committees as the business of Parliament may require, subject to ratification by Parliament.

ORDER 30.2 — Composition

- (1) Each Standing Committee shall consist of not fewer than five (5) and not more than eleven (11) Members, appointed by the Speaker on the basis of expressed interests, expertise, and community representation.
- (2) Each Standing Committee shall elect a Chairperson and a Vice Chairperson from among its Members at its inaugural meeting.

ORDER 30.3 — Functions of Standing Committees

- (1) Each Standing Committee shall: (a) scrutinise Bills referred to it by Parliament; (b) examine the work and expenditure of the relevant areas of the Assembly's activity; (c) conduct inquiries into matters of public concern within its mandate; (d) receive and consider petitions referred to it; (e) report its findings and recommendations to Parliament.

ARTICLE 31 — AD HOC AND SELECT COMMITTEES

ORDER 31.1 — Establishment

- (1) The Speaker, or Parliament by resolution, may establish an Ad Hoc Committee to investigate or consider a specific matter not within the standing mandate of any Standing Committee, or to conduct a joint review with the Assembly.
- (2) An Ad Hoc Committee shall be dissolved upon submission of its final report to Parliament.

ORDER 31.2 — Joint Committees

- (1) Parliament and the Assembly may establish Joint Committees comprising Members of both bodies to consider matters of common concern. Joint Committees shall be governed by procedures agreed upon by the Speaker and the President of the Assembly.



ARTICLE 32 — COMMITTEE PROCEDURE

ORDER 32.1 — Meetings

- (1) A Committee shall meet at such times and places as the Chairperson may direct, subject to the availability of Members and the facilities of Parliament.
- (2) The quorum of a Committee shall be a majority of its Members.

ORDER 32.2 — Public Hearings

- (1) A Committee may, in the discharge of its functions, hold public hearings and invite any person to appear before it to give evidence or make representations. A Committee may, by resolution, sit in camera for portions of its proceedings.

ORDER 32.3 — Committee Reports

- (1) Every Committee shall present a written report to Parliament upon the conclusion of its work on each matter referred to it. The report shall include: (a) the terms of reference; (b) a summary of evidence received; (c) the Committee's findings; (d) recommendations for action by Parliament.
- (2) A minority report may be appended by dissenting Members.

PART IX VOTING

ARTICLE 33 — METHODS OF VOTING

ORDER 33.1 — Voice Vote

- (1) The Speaker shall ordinarily first take a voice vote by requesting Members to say "Aye" or "No". If the result is clear, the Speaker shall declare the outcome.

ORDER 33.2 — Show of Hands

- (1) If the result of a voice vote is not clear, or if any Member so requests, the Speaker shall take the vote by show of hands and shall cause the Clerk to count.

ORDER 33.3 — Division

- (1) Parliament may vote by Division where: (a) the result of a show of hands is disputed; (b) the matter before Parliament requires a special majority; (c) any Member specifically requests a division before the result of the show of hands is declared.
- (2) In a Division, Members in favour shall stand on the right side of the Chamber and Members opposed shall stand on the left. Abstentions shall be recorded separately. The Serjeant-at-Arms shall assist the Clerk in the count.

ORDER 33.4 — Secret Ballot

- (1) Voting by secret ballot shall be used for: (a) the election of the Speaker and Deputy Speakers; (b) any motion for the removal of an Officer; (c) disciplinary matters resulting in potential suspension or expulsion; (d) any other matter where Parliament so resolves.

ARTICLE 34 — SIMPLE AND SPECIAL MAJORITIES

ORDER 34.1 — Simple Majority

- (1) Unless these Standing Orders or the BYM Constitution prescribe a special majority, all questions shall be decided by a simple majority of Members present and voting.

ORDER 34.2 — Special Majority

- (1) A two-thirds (2/3) majority of all Members of Parliament shall be required for: (a) the amendment of these Standing Orders; (b) a motion for the removal of any Officer of Parliament; (c) the suspension of Standing Orders; (d) expulsion of a Member from Parliament; (e) any resolution to reverse a previous resolution of Parliament within the same Session.

PART X

DISCIPLINARY PROCEDURES

ARTICLE 35 — MISCONDUCT AND BREACH OF ORDER

ORDER 35.1 — Calling to Order

- (1) Where a Member's conduct is disorderly or in breach of these Standing Orders, the Speaker shall first call the Member to order by name. If the Member persists, the Speaker may direct the Member to leave the Chamber for the remainder of the sitting.

ORDER 35.2 — Progressive Sanctions

- (1) The progressive sanctions available to the Speaker for misconduct are: (a) a formal warning on the record; (b) direction to leave the Chamber for the remainder of the sitting; (c) naming under Article 36; (d) recommendation to the Committee on Rules, Privileges, and Disciplinary Matters for investigation and further sanction.

ARTICLE 36 — NAMING AND SUSPENSION

ORDER 36.1 — Naming

- (1) If a Member persistently disregards the authority of the Chair, uses grossly unparliamentary language, or engages in conduct that is gravely disorderly, the Speaker may formally name the Member by saying: "I name the Honourable Member for [community], for [brief statement of offence]."
- (2) Immediately upon naming, the Speaker shall, without debate, put the question: "That the Honourable Member for [community] be suspended from the service of Parliament for the sitting day." If the motion is carried, the Member shall be directed to withdraw from the precincts of Parliament.

ORDER 36.2 — Extended Suspension and Expulsion

- (1) For repeated or particularly serious misconduct, the matter shall be referred to the Committee on Rules, Privileges, and Disciplinary Matters, which shall investigate and may recommend: (a) suspension for up to one (1) month; (b) expulsion from Parliament. The recommendation of the Committee shall be voted upon by Parliament and shall require a two-thirds majority.
- (2) A Member who has been expelled from Parliament may not be re-admitted to membership for a period of not less than one (1) parliamentary Session.

ARTICLE 37 — PARLIAMENTARY PRIVILEGES AND IMMUNITIES

ORDER 37.1 — Freedom of Speech



- (1) Subject to these Standing Orders, every Member shall have freedom of speech within the Chamber. No Member shall be liable to any action or proceeding outside Parliament in respect of words spoken in Parliament in the course of parliamentary proceedings.
- (2) This privilege shall not be interpreted so as to permit a Member to use language that is abusive, defamatory, or unparliamentary within the Chamber.

ORDER 37.2 — Contempt of Parliament

- (1) The following acts shall constitute contempt of Parliament: (a) wilful disobedience of a lawful order of Parliament or the Speaker; (b) deliberate misleading of Parliament; (c) assaulting, threatening, or intimidating a Member or Officer; (d) publishing false reports of parliamentary proceedings; (e) any act calculated to obstruct the business of Parliament.
- (2) Contempt may be dealt with by the Committee on Rules, Privileges, and Disciplinary Matters, which may recommend sanctions including suspension, expulsion, or referral to civil authorities as appropriate.



PART XI

RECORDS AND PUBLICATION

ARTICLE 38 — HANSARD AND MINUTES

ORDER 38.1 — Official Record

- (1) The Clerk shall cause to be recorded a verbatim account of all speeches, statements, and proceedings in Parliament, to be known as the Hansard.
- (2) The Hansard shall constitute the official and conclusive record of parliamentary proceedings. No evidence contrary to the Hansard shall be admissible in any parliamentary inquiry.
- (3) The Hansard shall be published within ten (10) days of each sitting and made available to Members and the public.

ORDER 38.2 — Minutes

- (1) In addition to the Hansard, the Clerk shall maintain formal Minutes of each sitting recording:
 - (a) the date, time, and place of sitting;
 - (b) the names of Members present;
 - (c) the business transacted;
 - (d) all motions, votes, and their results;
 - (e) all rulings of the Speaker.
- (2) Minutes shall be confirmed at the next sitting and signed by the Speaker as a true record.

ARTICLE 39 — PUBLIC ACCESS AND TRANSPARENCY

ORDER 39.1 — Publication

- (1) All Bills, Resolutions, Committee Reports, and the Hansard shall be made available for public inspection at the offices of Parliament and, where practicable, published on any official digital platform of the Movement.
- (2) The Clerk shall maintain a public registry of all parliamentary documents and shall make them available to any member of the public on reasonable request.

ORDER 39.2 — Media Access

- (1) Accredited media organisations may be granted access to parliament in accordance with procedures prescribed by the Speaker in consultation with the Clerk.

PART XII AMENDMENT AND REVIEW

ARTICLE 40 — AMENDMENT OF STANDING ORDERS

ORDER 40.1 — Procedure for Amendment

- (1) These Standing Orders may be amended by Parliament on a motion for amendment supported by not less than two-thirds (2/3) of all Members of Parliament.
- (2) Notice of a motion to amend these Standing Orders shall be given to the Clerk not less than fourteen (14) days before the sitting at which the motion is to be moved.
- (3) Any proposed amendment shall be circulated to all Members not less than seven (7) days before the sitting.

ORDER 40.2 — Periodic Review

- (1) Parliament shall conduct a comprehensive review of these Standing Orders at the commencement of every alternate parliamentary Session, with a view to ensuring that they remain fit for purpose and reflective of the Movement's evolving needs.

ARTICLE 41 — SUSPENSION OF STANDING ORDERS

ORDER 41.1 — Temporary Suspension

- (1) Any provision of these Standing Orders may be suspended for the purposes of a particular sitting by a resolution supported by two-thirds (2/3) of Members present and voting, upon a motion moved without notice.
- (2) A suspension shall not be used as a device to circumvent the fundamental rights of Members or to suppress legitimate parliamentary opposition.



SCHEDULES TO THE BEKWAI YOUTH PARLIAMENT STANDING ORDERS

SCHEDULE I — OATH OF OFFICE FOR MEMBERS OF PARLIAMENT

OATH OF OFFICE

I, _____, do solemnly swear/affirm that I will faithfully and honestly fulfil my duties as a Member of the Bekwai Youth Parliament; that I will uphold and defend the Constitution of the Bekwai Youth Movement; that I will at all times place the interests of the youth and communities of Bekwai above all partisan, personal, or sectional interests; that I will respect the Standing Orders of the Parliament and abide by the lawful rulings of the Speaker; and that I will not divulge or improperly use any confidential information entrusted to me in the course of my service.

[Signed] _____ Date: _____
Witnessed by the Speaker of the Bekwai Youth Parliament

SCHEDULE II — STANDARD NOTICE OF MOTION

Field	Details
Name of Member	
Community Represented	
Date of Notice	
Proposed Sitting Date	
Title of Motion	
Full Text of Motion	
Grounds / Justification	
Seconder (if known)	
Documents Annexed	

SCHEDULE III — STANDARD FORM OF A BILL

**A BILL ENTITLED:**

AN ACT / RESOLUTION OF THE BEKWAI YOUTH PARLIAMENT to [state purpose], and for connected purposes.

PREAMBLE:

WHEREAS [state background and justification for the Bill]...

ENACTED BY THE BEKWAI YOUTH PARLIAMENT AS FOLLOWS:

Section 1 — [Clause title]: [Content of clause]

Sponsor: _____ Date: _____ Seconder:

SCHEDULE IV — STANDING COMMITTEE STRUCTURE

Committee	Primary Mandate	Min. Members
Education, Youth & Skills Dev.	Bills and matters on youth education, skills, and employment	5
Health, Sanitation & Environment	Public health, sanitation infrastructure, and environmental matters	5
Agriculture, Trade & Economic Dev.	Agribusiness, enterprise development, and trade matters	5
Community Infrastructure & Housing	Roads, water, housing, and physical development matters	5
Gender, Social Welfare & Inclusion	Gender equity, child welfare, disability, and social protection	5
Security, Peace & Conflict Resolution	Community safety, peace-building, and conflict mediation	5
Rules, Privileges & Disciplinary Matters	Oversight of Standing Orders, member conduct, and privileges	5
Finance & Resource Mobilisation	Movement budgets, fundraising, donor management	5

SCHEDULE V — SPEAKER'S RULINGS REGISTER FORMAT

Field	Detail
Ruling Reference Number	BYP/SPK/[Year]/[Serial Number]
Date of Ruling	
Sitting Number	



Field	Detail
Nature of Ruling	Point of Order / Challenge to Ruling / Procedural Decision
Question Arising	
Speaker's Decision	
Precedent(s) Relied Upon	
Dissent (if any)	
Notes	

CERTIFICATION OF ADOPTION

THESE STANDING ORDERS were duly adopted by the BYM Youth General Assembly of the Bekwai Youth Movement at a meeting duly convened and held at Sefwi Bekwai in the Western North Region of the Republic of Ghana, on this _____ day of _____ in the year 20_____.

Signed by the President of the BYM Youth General Assembly:

Name: _____ Signature: _____
Date: _____

Countersigned by the Speaker of the Bekwai Youth Parliament:

Name: _____ Signature: _____
Date: _____

Sealed with the Official Seal of the Bekwai Youth Movement:

[SEAL]